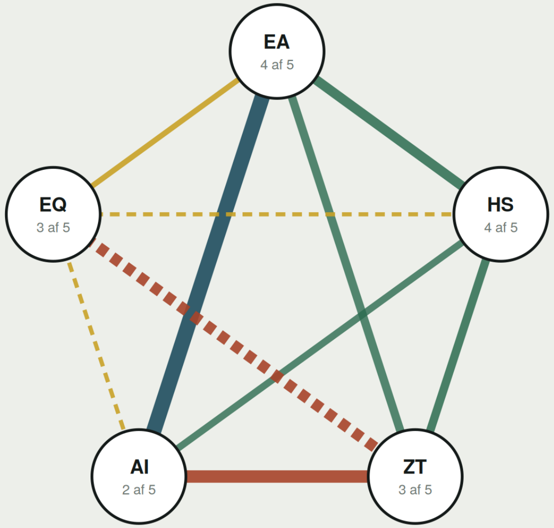
MATURITY AND COUPLINGS

Five domains. Ten couplings. Twenty directions.

Two good domains can have a bad coupling. A maturity score never shows that picture, and that is why this report exists.



Contents

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METHOD

How to read it

Three levels. The number is the entry point, not the answer.

1

Sub-dimensions

Each domain is measured on four to seven sub-dimensions. Each is scored 1-5 or unknown, with source and independence marking.

2

Domain score

A weighted average gives the domain's number. The weight set is versioned, otherwise two measurements cannot be compared over time.

3

Coupling debt

An edge takes its debt from where two domains' weak dimensions meet. That is where the work sits.

Why not simply a radar chart

A radar chart shows five axes, that is, the domains separately. Any maturity tool can deliver that. The pentagon with its diagonals, by contrast, has exactly ten edges, and those are the ten pairs.

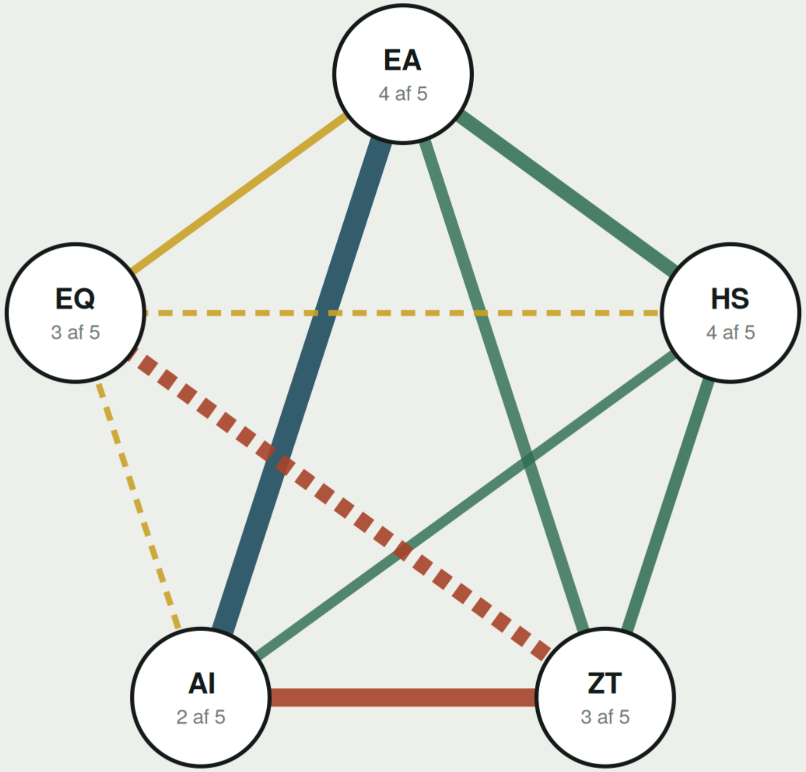
The nodes are context. The edges are the product.

The average hides

A domain at 3.9 with one dimension at 1 is more dangerous than a domain at 2.8 with no outliers. The weakest dimension is therefore always marked.

Ten edges, four with debt

Thickness is degree of coupling. Colour is debt.



The edge carries two values

Thickness = degree of coupling

how much the two domains actually depend on each other in operation

Colour = debt

- owned and confirmed
- outdated or unresolved
- no owner, aktiv debt
- never established

Why not a radar chart

A radar chart shows five axes, that is, the five domains' maturity separately. Every maturity tool can deliver that.

The pentagon with its diagonals has exactly ten edges. Those are the ten pairs. The edges are what others measure.

The nodes are context. The edges are the product, and they can be red even when all five nodes are green.

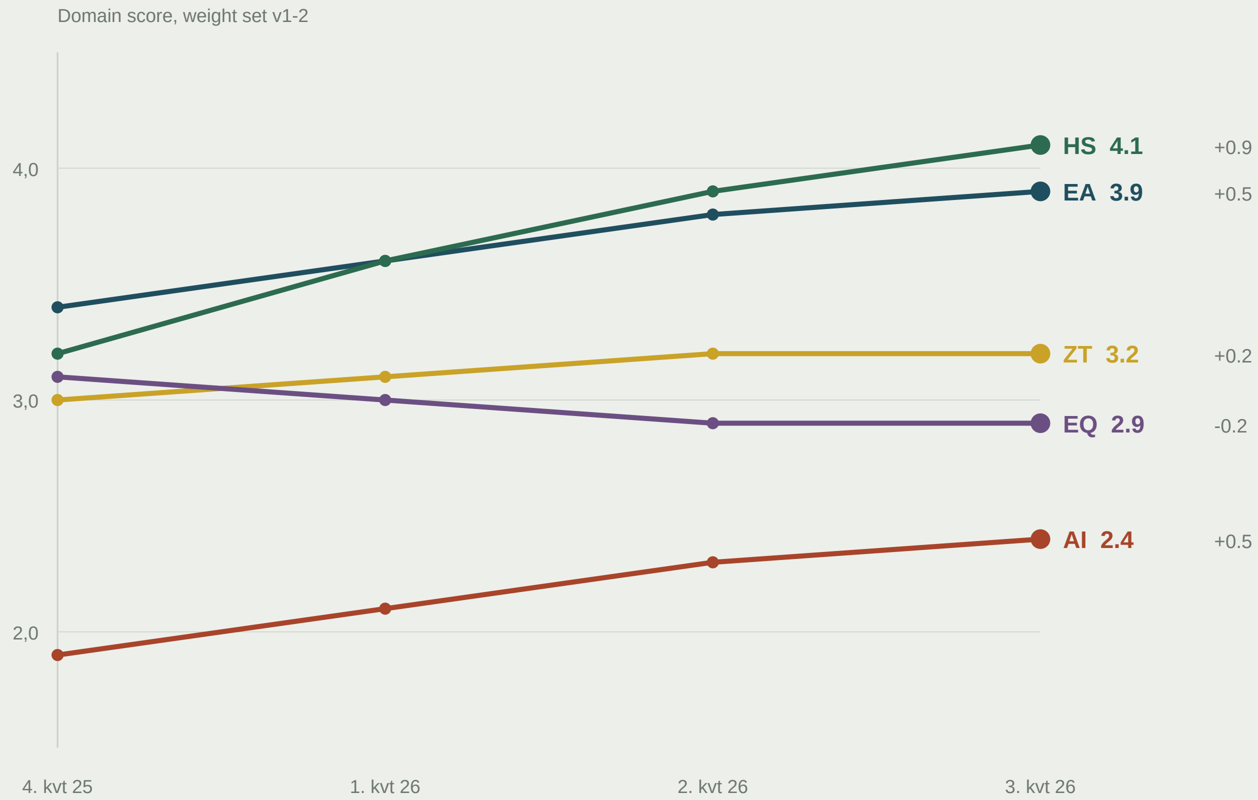
The reading in this synthetic example

Four of five domains stand at 3 or 4 out of 5. Even so, ZT x AI is the thickest red edge: high dependency, no owner. And ZT x EQ was never established, although both domains score 3. Two good domains can have a **bad coupling, and that is the picture a maturity score alone never shows.**

PACE

Are the domains moving in step

Four measurements on the same axis. The level is one question. The gap in pace is another.



Largest divergence in pace

Hyperscale has moved 0.9. Zero Trust has moved 0.2. The two are tightly coupled, and the gap has widened every quarter.

HS × ZT · 0.7 in operation

The only domain that is falling

Psychological safety is moving downward while Hyperscale accelerates. That combination is rarely accidental.

A domain standing still is not the problem. A domain standing still while its neighbour runs, is.

Pace is measured only between domains that are actually coupled. Two uncoupled domains may move differently.

Sub-dimensions and weights

A red dot marks the weakest dimension. That is what drives the debt on an edge.

EA and semantic layer

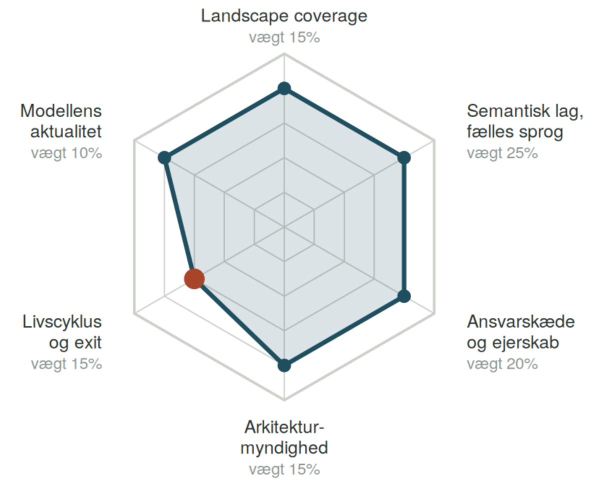
6 underdimensioner · vægtet gennemsnit

3,9

af 5

Weakest underdimension
Livscyklus og exit: 3 af 5
vægt 15% · skjult af gennemsnittet

Rød prik = den underdimension der typisk driver gælden på en kant i koblingsgrafen.



Hyperscale Cloud

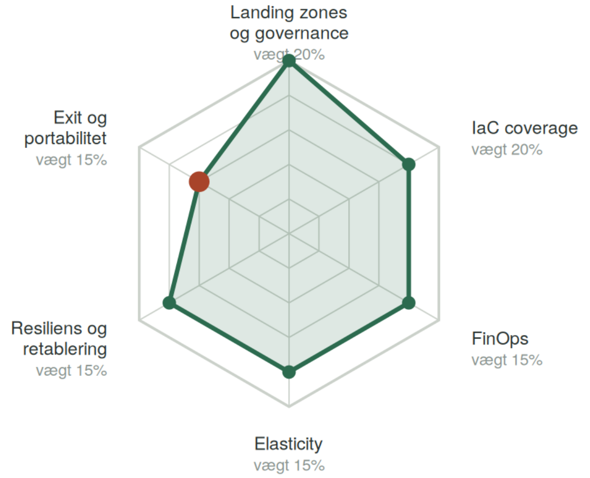
6 underdimensioner · vægtet gennemsnit

4,1

af 5

Weakest underdimension
Exit og portabilitet: 3 af 5
vægt 15% · skjult af gennemsnittet

Rød prik = den underdimension der typisk driver gælden på en kant i koblingsgrafen.



MATURITY PER DOMAIN

Sub-dimensions and weights

A red dot marks the weakest dimension. That is what drives the debt on an edge.

Zero Trust and sovereignty

7 underdimensioner · vægtet gennemsnit

3,2

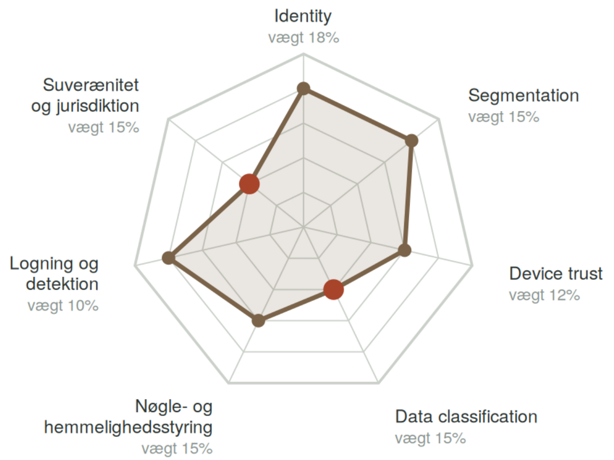
af 5

Weakest underdimension

Data classification: 2 af 5

vægt 15% · skjult af gennemsnittet

Rød prik = den underdimension der typisk driver gælden på en kant i koblingsgrafen.



AI Capability

5 underdimensioner · vægtet gennemsnit

2,4

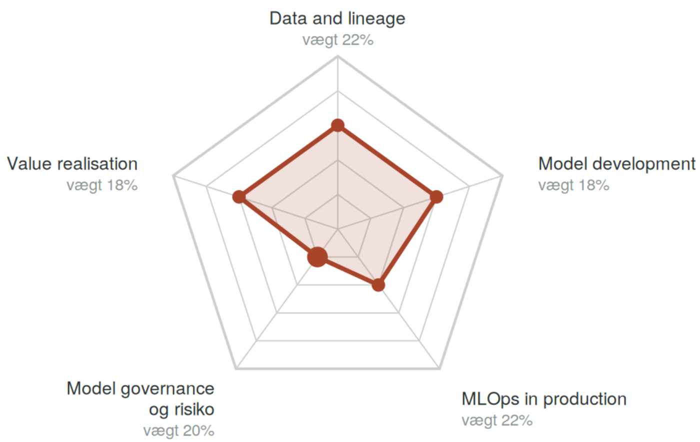
af 5

Weakest underdimension

Model governance og risiko: 1 af 5

vægt 20% · skjult af gennemsnittet

Rød prik = den underdimension der typisk driver gælden på en kant i koblingsgrafen.



MATURITY PER DOMAIN

Sub-dimensions and weights

A red dot marks the weakest dimension. That is what drives the debt on an edge.

Psychological safety

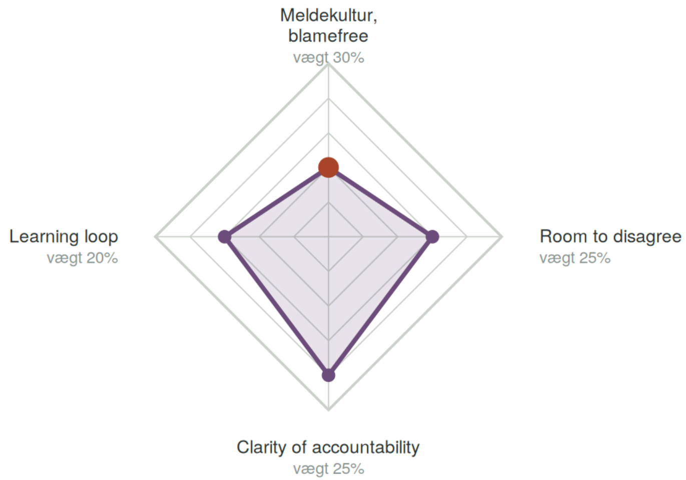
4 underdimensioner · vægtet gennemsnit

2,9

af 5

Weakest underdimension
Meldekultur, blamefree: 2 af 5
vægt 30% · skjult af gennemsnittet

Rød prik = den underdimension der typisk driver gælden på en kant i koblingsgrafen.



Overall reading

Four of five domains sit at 3 or 4 out of 5. Even so, three couplings are critical and two were never established.

The organisation is not immature. It is immature between its parts.

That is a different task with a different price. Raising maturity in a domain is bought from a domain supplier. Debt in a coupling has no supplier, because it sits between two contracts.

Four edges without an owner · three critical · two never established · two unknown

UNFOLDED

Twenty directional couplings

The row draws on the column. EA toward AI is not the same as AI toward EA.

DRAWS ON →	EA	HS	ZT	AI	EQ
EA	core	**OK** Landing zones follow the architecture	**OK** Trust boundaries as a pattern	**DEBT** Semantic layer settled, but lineage is missing at the other end	**PARTIAL** Accountability chain written down, not lived
HS	**PARTIAL** Nobody says what may be retired	core	**OK** Identity is the unifying perimeter	**OK** Capacity exists, is not used	**UNKNOWN** Automation versus fear of surveillance never examined
ZT	**DEBT** Classification not anchored in the architecture	**PARTIAL** Keys in the cloud, custody unresolved	core	**CRITICAL** No approval of models' data access	**CRITICAL** Incidents go unreported because they feel like blame
AI	**DEBT** Models build on 14 variants of the same concept	**OK** Elastic compute available	**CRITICAL** Uses data without known classification	core	**NOT ESTABL.** Nobody dares say the model is wrong
EQ	**OK** Clear boundaries give structural safety	**UNKNOWN** Toil reduction not experienced as relief	**CRITICAL** Security is experienced as punishment	**NOT ESTABL.** Shared accountability for probabilistic output does not exist	core

OK PARTIAL DEBT CRITICAL UNKNOWN NOT ESTABL.

Unknown is not the same as low. It means nobody has looked, and that is often the more important fact.

FOOTHOLDS

The substitution account

Where you stand on your own, and where you stand on someone else's shoulders. Coupling ownership stated plainly.

DOMAIN	OWN FOOTHOLD	WHAT IT MEANS IN PRACTICE
EA and semantic layer	60% · 25% · 15%	The drawings are yours. The concept layer is not.
Hyperscale Cloud	25% · 30% · 45%	Landing zones were built by the partner and are maintained there.
Zero Trust	40% · 35% · 25%	The policies are yours. The keys sit in the supplier's KMS.
AI Capability	15% · 20% · 65%	Model, prompt and evaluation sit outside the house.
Psychological safety	85% · 15%	Cannot be bought and cannot be outsourced.

Own foothold · Shared with supplier · The supplier's

Foothold is not the same as maturity

AI scores 2.4 and has 15% foothold. Hyperscale scores 4.1 and has 25%. The high number was built by someone else, and it stands or falls with a contract. A domain can be mature and leased at the same time.

RECOMMENDATIONS

Six moves, in order

The order follows how many edges are unlocked per unit spent, not how low the score is.

1 **Appoint an owner for the four ownerless edges**
ZT×AI, ZT×EQ, AI×EQ and HS×EQ have no owner. Ownership is an executive decision, not a project.
Unlocks four edges. No cost.

2 **Carry out data classification**
Zero Trust's weakest dimension at 2 drives debt toward both AI and Hyperscale. Six to eight workshops.
A precondition for three other moves.

3 **Introduce an approval gate for models' data access**
AI model governance stands at 1 and weighs 20%. The gate must cover what already runs, not only what is new.
Removes the heaviest critical edge.

4 **Set a target for self-reported incidents**
Reporting culture at 2 weighs 30% of EQ. The target is the share of incidents reported by whoever caused them.
Cheapest in money, most expensive in courage.

5 **Test exit on one real workload**
Hyperscale scores 4.1, but exit has never been tried. Assessments without a test do not hold in a negotiation.
Three to four weeks of work.

6 **Settle one shared concept end to end**
The semantic layer weighs 25% of EA. Choose the concept that appears in most systems, and let it be a contract.
Slow, but unlocks EA×AI.

Where coupling debt becomes an incident

Derived from the critical edges. Not a new assessment, but the same one read as risk.

COUPLING	WHAT HAPPENS	WHAT TRIGGERS IT	WHO ANSWERS TODAY	WHEN IT IS FOUND
ZT × AI	A model accesses data without known legal basis	A freedom-of-information request or an inspection	Nobody appointed	At inspection. Not before.
AI × ZT	Unclassified data is used in operation	A dataset with personal data enters training	Nobody appointed	At the first subject access request
ZT × EQ	An incident is found late because it is not reported	An employee sees something and does not speak up	Head of security, without a mandate over culture	Weeks. Measured at three in the last case.
AI × EQ	A model error passes because nobody objects	A recommendation that is wrong in an individual case	None. No accountability model exists	When the citizen or customer complains
HS × EQ	Unknown. Nobody has looked	Unknown	Unknown	Cannot be assessed

None of the five has an owner with a mandate

Three have nobody appointed. One has someone appointed without a mandate over the cause. One is unknown. The risk sits between two areas of responsibility, and a responsibility shared by two is carried by none.

For the board minutes

The column that matters is not the first but the fourth. An ownership gap can be written down and closed in a meeting. An incident cannot.

EFFECT AND CONSEQUENCE

What is gained, and what it costs

Effect in three forms. Consequence in two. Figures are illustrative.

	EFFECT			CONSEQUENCE	
MOVE	ECONOMY	MATURITY	CO2	EFFORT	COST
Ownership on four edges	None direct	+0.0 but four edges from red to amber	None	Low. One decision and four conversations	No money. Management time
Data classification	Enables rightsizing of over-protected workloads	ZT 3,2 til 3,7	Less over-provisioning	Medium. Six to eight cross-cutting workshops	Internal time. No licence
Approval gate, AI	Avoids models being halted in operation at inspection	AI 2,4 til 3,0	Neutral	High. Delays two models in the pipeline	Roughly one person-year spread over three months
Target for self-reported incidents	Shorter detection time lowers incident cost	EQ 2,9 til 3,5	Neutral	High, but not in hours. Management must change behaviour	Near zero
Exit test on one workload	Negotiating position at the next renewal	HS 4,1 til 4,4	May reveal overspend	Mellem. Tre til fire uger	Real cost in hours and test environment
One shared concept end to end	Fewer errors in cross-cutting reporting	EA 3,9 til 4,2	Neutral	High. Cross-organisational and slow	Intern tid over to kvartaler

Note that the moves with the greatest effect per unit spent are the ones that cost no money. That is typical, and it is also why they are left undone.